

GVA Downloader

Version 2.0 — Updated User Guide

A complete walkthrough of every menu, workflow, and setting in the current GVA Downloader v2.0 script — covering downloads, playlists, search, history, settings, and command-line usage.

Fast • **Portable** • **Cross-Platform**

Windows · Android (Termux) · Linux · macOS

ENGINE

yt-dlp

INTERFACE

Rich Terminal

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This edition is synchronized with the supplied v2.0 Python script (`gva_downloader.py`). It documents the seven built-in themes, the Play History Item action, and the direct-URL / command-line workflow exactly as implemented.

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Synchronization notes: this guide reflects the supplied v2.0 script exactly as written. It contains seven themes, a Play History Item action, a startup dependency check, a fixed SponsorBlock post-processor pipeline, and a portable application-folder layout. Older documentation that lists only three themes, omits play history, or references a hidden home-directory config folder is superseded by this guide.

01 Overview & Requirements

GVA Downloader v2.0 is a terminal-based media downloader built on **yt-dlp** and **Rich**. The application is fully portable: every file it owns — settings, history, logs, cache, and temporary files — lives inside the same folder as the script itself (`APP_DIR`), rather than a hidden folder in your home directory.

Key Capabilities

- Video download with dynamic quality selection
- Audio download with bitrate and MP3 / M4A / AAC / FLAC / OGG / WAV output
- Playlist download as video or audio, with full or custom item ranges
- YouTube search and download, directly from the terminal
- Batch downloads from pasted links or a text file
- Media information preview without downloading
- Download history with play / open / delete / clear actions
- Settings for download folder, quality labels, theme, and overwrite behavior
- yt-dlp update and cache maintenance
- Direct URL quick-download mode
- Termux Share-to-Download workflow
- Safe filenames, duplicate handling, and single-line download progress
- Optional subtitles, metadata, thumbnails, and SponsorBlock for video

Requirements

Component	Notes
Python 3.9+	Runtime the application is built on
yt-dlp	Python package — the download engine
rich	Python package — powers the terminal interface
Internet connection	Required for media extraction and downloads
FFmpeg	External program — required for video/audio merging, audio conversion, thumbnail embedding, and related post-processing

STARTUP CHECK

The application performs a dependency check every time it starts and reports any missing components (Python, yt-dlp, Rich, FFmpeg) directly in the terminal, along with guidance on how to fix them.

02 Installation

Windows — Automatic

Run the installer script:

```
install_windows.bat
```

The installer checks Python, upgrades pip, installs the packages from `requirements.txt`, prepares the GVA application folders, and checks whether FFmpeg is available on PATH.

Windows — Manual

```
python -m pip install -U -r requirements.txt
python gva_downloader.py
```

Android / Termux

```
pkg install git -y
git clone <repository-url> "GVA Downloader"
cd "GVA Downloader"
bash install_termux.sh
```

The Termux installer installs Python and FFmpeg, installs dependencies from `requirements.txt`, prepares the application folder, requests storage access, and optionally creates the Share-to-Download opener.

Linux

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install python3 python3-pip ffmpeg -y
python3 -m pip install -U -r requirements.txt
python3 gva_downloader.py
```

macOS

```
brew install python ffmpeg
python3 -m pip install -U -r requirements.txt
python3 gva_downloader.py
```

03 First Run & Folder Structure

Running the application for the first time creates every folder it needs automatically.

```
GVA Downloader/  
├─ gva_downloader.py  
├─ README.md  
├─ requirements.txt  
├─ install_windows.bat  
├─ install_termux.sh  
├─ LICENSE  
├─ .gitignore  
├─  
├─ downloads/  
│   ├─ videos/  
│   └─ audios/  
├─ config/  
│   └─ settings.json  
├─ history/  
│   └─ history.json  
├─ logs/  
│   └─ gva_downloader.log  
├─ cache/  
└─ temp/
```

Portable Behavior

Application-owned data — configuration, history, logs, cache, and temp files — always stays inside the GVA Downloader folder. The **Download Folder** setting may instead point to an external absolute path; GVA creates separate `videos/` and `audios/` directories inside whichever root you choose.

NOTE

A relative download folder (the default, `"downloads"`) is always resolved against the application folder, keeping the app fully portable. An absolute path you set in Settings is used exactly as given.

04 Main Menu

The main menu is organized into four groups and accepts choices 1 through 12:

DOWNLOAD

- 1 Download Video
- 2 Download Audio
- 3 Playlist Download (Video/Audio)

MANAGE

- 7 Download History
- 8 Settings
- 9 Engine Maintenance (Update/Cache)

DISCOVER

- 4 Search YouTube & Download
- 5 Batch Downloads (List/File)
- 6 Media Information

SUPPORT

- 10 Help
- 11 About
- 12 Exit

Media Information

Enter a URL to preview its title, uploader, duration, view count, and available formats/qualities — without downloading anything.

Help & About

Help summarizes the main workflows directly in the terminal. **About** shows the application version, author, platform, engine, language, active theme, and the application folder path.

05 Download Workflows

Video

The video downloader fetches source information, presents dynamic quality options pulled live from the link, then asks about subtitles, metadata, thumbnail embedding, and SponsorBlock. Duplicate handling occurs before the download starts, and a single progress line tracks the active download.

FFMPEG-DEPENDENT OPTIONS

If you choose to embed a thumbnail, embed metadata, or use SponsorBlock, GVA verifies FFmpeg is available before continuing.

Audio

The audio downloader checks FFmpeg first, fetches source information, offers dynamic audio bitrate choices, then asks for an output format and metadata/cover-art options.

Supported formats: MP3, M4A, AAC, FLAC, OGG, WAV.

NOTE

Cover-art embedding is applied only for MP3, M4A, and FLAC output.

Playlist

Playlist mode detects the playlist automatically and lets you choose all items or a custom range such as `1-10`, with video or audio output. Playlist filenames use an index prefix, for example `01 - Title.mp4`.

Search

Search YouTube directly from the terminal, select a result, and continue through the normal video or audio download flow.

Batch

Paste multiple URLs, or load a text file containing one URL per line. GVA processes the links sequentially.

06 History & Settings

Download History

- 1 View History
- 2 Search History
- 3 Play History Item
- 4 Open Download Location
- 5 Delete History Entry
- 6 Clear History
- 7 Back

Play History Item opens an existing downloaded file using the platform's default media player. If the recorded file is missing from disk, GVA reports the missing path instead of failing silently.

Settings

- 1 Download Folder
- 2 Default Video Quality label
- 3 Default Audio Quality label
- 4 Theme
- 5 Overwrite Existing Files
- 6 Reset Settings

The stored video/audio quality values are reference/default labels only. The actual quality lists shown during a download are always obtained dynamically from the source at download time.

07 Direct URL & Command Line

The script accepts a positional URL, an explicit `--url` flag, or several quick-action flags:

```
python gva_downloader.py
python gva_downloader.py "URL"
python gva_downloader.py --url "URL"
python gva_downloader.py --video "URL"
python gva_downloader.py --audio "URL"
python gva_downloader.py --info "URL"
python gva_downloader.py --history
python gva_downloader.py --settings
```

Passing a bare URL (or `--url`) opens a compact quick-download menu:

- 1 Download Video
- 2 Download Audio
- 3 Download Best Quality
- 4 View Information
- 5 Cancel

`--video`, `--audio`, and `--info` skip this menu entirely and jump straight into the corresponding action. `--history` prints download history and exits; `--settings` opens the interactive settings menu and exits.

NOTE

This same direct-URL path is what powers the Android Termux share workflow described in the next section.

08 Android Share Workflow

The Termux installer can create `~/bin/termux-url-opener`. When a supported app shares a URL to Termux, the opener passes that URL straight to GVA Downloader.

```
YouTube / media app
|  Share
▼
Termux
|  ~/bin/termux-url-opener
▼
GVA Downloader
|
▼
Quick URL Menu
```

The generated opener calls the application's canonical filename, `gva_downloader.py`.

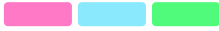
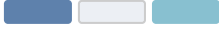
SHARED ANDROID STORAGE

Run `termux-setup-storage` once, then set your Download Folder to a path under `~/storage/downloads/` so downloaded files are visible outside Termux.

09 Themes, Duplicates & Filename Safety

Built-in Themes

The current script ships with seven themes, each with a signature color palette and emoji:

default — Default	
ocean — Ocean	
sunset — Sunset	
dracula — Dracula	
nord — Nord	
cyberpunk — Cyberpunk	
forest — Forest	

NOTE

Themes only change the terminal's colors and icons — they have no effect on download behavior. Switch themes any time from Settings → Theme.

Duplicate Handling

When a file with the same name already exists in the destination folder, GVA prompts:

- 1 Skip
- 2 Overwrite
- 3 Save with a new filename
- 4 Cancel

If **Overwrite Existing Files** is enabled in Settings, this prompt is bypassed entirely and existing files are overwritten automatically.

Filename Safety

The current script replaces Windows-invalid filename characters, removes control characters and trailing dots/spaces, protects Windows reserved device names (such as `CON`, `PRN`, `COM1`), and limits overly long filenames while preserving the file extension.

10 Engine Maintenance & Troubleshooting

Engine Maintenance

The application provides actions to update yt-dlp, clear yt-dlp's cache, and clear GVA's own cache/temp directories.

```
python -m pip install -U yt-dlp
```

Common Problems

Problem	Action
rich missing	<code>python -m pip install -U rich</code>
yt-dlp missing/ outdated	<code>python -m pip install -U yt-dlp</code>
FFmpeg missing	Install FFmpeg and add it to PATH; Termux: <code>pkg install ffmpeg -y</code>
Android files not visible	Run <code>termux-setup-storage</code> and choose a folder under <code>~/storage/downloads/</code>
Extraction error	Update yt-dlp and retry; inspect <code>logs/gva_downloader.log</code>

All technical errors are logged to `logs/gva_downloader.log` inside the application folder.

11 Responsible Use & Command Cheat Sheet

Responsible Use

GVA Downloader uses yt-dlp and does not implement custom scraping or bypass DRM, authentication, paywalls, or access controls. Use the application only for content you are authorized to access, and respect the terms of the services you use.

Command Cheat Sheet

Goal	Command
Install (Windows)	<code>install_windows.bat</code>
Install (Termux)	<code>bash install_termux.sh</code>
Run app	<code>python gva_downloader.py</code>
Direct URL	<code>python gva_downloader.py "URL"</code>
Quick video	<code>python gva_downloader.py --video "URL"</code>
Quick audio	<code>python gva_downloader.py --audio "URL"</code>
Information only	<code>python gva_downloader.py --info "URL"</code>
History	<code>python gva_downloader.py --history</code>
Settings	<code>python gva_downloader.py --settings</code>
Update yt-dlp	<code>python -m pip install -U yt-dlp</code>

GVA Downloader v2.0 is built on yt-dlp for downloading and FFmpeg for media processing, with a fully portable application folder that keeps settings, history, logs, cache, and temp files alongside the script itself.